

ARTICLE I: GOVERNANCE AND INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY BOUNDARIES

1.1 Scope and Status

This Framework constitutes the independent intellectual work of its author and is presented as an Independent Conceptual Governance Framework for the deployment of Agentic Artificial Intelligence within the Internal Audit Function.

It is intended exclusively for research, education, professional discussion, governance enhancement, and organizational risk management. This Framework neither transfers, licenses, incorporates, nor claims ownership of any third-party proprietary technology, software, commercial methodology, intellectual property, confidential information, or trade secret.

1.2 Human Accountability Principle

The governing principle of this Framework is:

"The Automated Agent Network Executes; The Human Decision-Maker Authorizes."

All material audit judgments, governance decisions, risk assessments, approvals, assurance conclusions, and organizational authorizations shall remain subject to meaningful human review and authorization.

Ultimate accountability shall remain with the designated human decision-maker and the organization in accordance with applicable laws, contractual obligations, internal governance requirements, and organizational policies. Autonomous AI systems shall not independently issue binding organizational decisions without appropriate human authorization.

1.3 Intellectual Property

Unless expressly acknowledged otherwise, the original concepts, governance architecture, terminology, structural design, visual models, and methodology contained within this Framework represent the independent intellectual work of the author.

1.4 No Endorsement

Nothing contained within this Framework shall be interpreted as creating or implying any endorsement, affiliation, authorization, sponsorship, approval, partnership, or representation by or with any government, regulatory authority, professional body, academic institution, commercial organization, consulting firm, technology provider, or any other third party.

ARTICLE II: GOVERNANCE AND OPERATIONAL CONTROL

2.1 Governance Compliance

Implementation of this Framework should remain consistent with applicable laws, contractual obligations, organizational governance requirements, internal policies, and operational risk management practices.

Nothing contained within this Framework supersedes, replaces, limits, or modifies any legal, contractual, fiduciary, governance, or organizational obligation.

2.2 Organizational Governance

Organizations implementing this Framework should maintain appropriate governance over AI models, prompts, configurations, validation activities, access controls, monitoring processes, and

organizational information through appropriately qualified personnel designated by the organization.

ARTICLE III: FORENSIC INTEGRITY AND AUDIT EVIDENCE

3.1 Reproducible Evidence

Organizations should maintain reproducible and verifiable evidence supporting AI-assisted activities to strengthen governance, accountability, assurance, investigations, and independent verification where appropriate.

3.2 Immutable Audit Records

Where technically and operationally appropriate, organizations should maintain immutable audit records using secure evidence preservation mechanisms capable of maintaining integrity, traceability, authenticity, accountability, and auditability throughout the governance lifecycle.

ARTICLE IV: OPERATIONAL RISK GOVERNANCE AND AUDIT INDEPENDENCE

4.1 Risk Ownership

Ownership of organizational risks should remain with designated management functions responsible for identifying, assessing, managing, monitoring, and reporting organizational risks.

Internal Audit shall preserve its organizational independence while providing objective assurance over governance, risk management, and internal control processes.

4.2 Independent Assurance

Internal Audit should independently evaluate the effectiveness of AI governance, operational resilience, internal controls, and organizational risk management. Any sampling methodologies, validation procedures, testing thresholds, or assurance mechanisms described within this Framework are illustrative governance practices and should be applied using professional judgment and organizational risk assessments.

ARTICLE V: GENERAL LEGAL DISCLAIMER

This Framework is published solely for educational, research, professional discussion, and governance purposes. It does not constitute legal, regulatory, audit, accounting, financial, tax, cybersecurity, or other professional advice. Organizations should obtain independent professional advice before adopting or implementing any part of this Framework.

The author makes no representation or warranty that this Framework alone satisfies any legal, regulatory, contractual, or organizational requirement. Responsibility for implementation remains with the adopting organization and its authorized decision-makers.